

Shloka Mardikar

CSE-AIML

Company: Baker Hughes

Job Profile: Digital Technology Intern

Offer Type: 6 month Internship + Performance based PPO

Internship Stipend: 40k

CTC: 11 lpa

Location: Powai / Airoli

Process Date: Technical Test - 11/8/2025

Digital Interview - 12/8/2025

Technical and Leadership round - 14/8/2025

Backstory:

Let me start by saying, the placement process is going to be **rigorous**, there will be several ups and downs and you might have to face many **challenges and rejections** before landing your **first offer**. There will be people who crack the OA's and interviews as well and get placed in one go, while there will be several of them who might still struggle whether it be clearing OA's or Tech round or HR. Believe me **luck plays a major role** in these processes, but that is something you definitely **can't control**. What you can do is **give your best and leave the rest to God**. Let me walk you through my experiences. I had cleared 4 OA's before Baker Hughes, I am listing down all the mistakes I made in them which you guys should definitely avoid.

Incred: I cleared their test and even their first round. I couldn't clear the last round because I got sidetracked from the main question and started explaining off topic. (**Lesson: Don't do this, always keep your answer to the point and crisp.**)

Barclays: I was excited to clear the OA and had set my mind on joining this company. In the interview, I was asked to write the backend code of my project with refined logic. Instead of admitting I wasn't sure, I spent most of the time trying to figure it out, leaving no time for other questions. (**Lesson: if you're unsure, be upfront so the interviewer can move on to areas you're confident in.**) I wasn't selected for further rounds, but it was a learning experience and I quickly shifted focus to the next opportunities.

Nomura: I was shortlisted for the GM role based on my resume and test scores, even though I hadn't applied. I couldn't clear the GD round despite good communication and valid points. I realized interrupting once and maintaining a casual body language worked against me. (**Lesson: keep your attitude professional and avoid interrupting others.**)

ISS Stoxx: The first tech round focused on Java OOPs, SQL, puzzles, and DSA. I went in nervous yet overconfident, skipping revision, which cost me when in-depth questions came up. (**Lesson: Always revise core topics at least a day before the interview.**)

After ISS, I was in full surrender mode, doubting myself and the choices I had made so far. But looking back, this phase was actually a sign that I was much closer to my destination than I thought. If I had truly given up then, I wouldn't have come this far. **SO DON'T EVER GIVE UP!!!**

Placement Process:

Eligibility Criteria was 6.5+ CGPA, No Backlogs and Resume shortlisting. All branches were eligible (not sure about MCA).

1. **OA Round** [167 candidates appeared, 46 shortlisted] (**Invigilation was done by the company**)

Platform: Microsoft forms

Duration: 30 mins

No. of questions: 25

The test consisted of topics covering SQL, output based questions (python/Java), Aptitude, OS, CCN, DSA, Cloud Computing. If you have a strong grip on CS core subjects, this test would be comparatively easier for you. Time management is key so attempt confident questions first, then move to elimination or educated guesses. I hadn't prepared for Cloud Computing and CCN well, which had cost me several marks, so make sure to cover these areas as well. (**My story:** After discussing with friends after the test, I was convinced I wouldn't be shortlisted. My *dukh-daard-peedha* continued, and with a heavy heart I went off to Taco Bell for lunch. To my surprise, while eating, I got an email from Baker Hughes saying I was shortlisted for the digital interview round. That instantly lifted my mood and I left for home and started preparing for it. So guys, don't lose hope until results are declared ;))

2. **Digital Interview** [46 candidates appeared, 35 shortlisted]

This was conducted on the Hire Vue platform same as JMPC CFG. Below were the questions asked, these people are asking the same questions from the past two years so chances are they might repeat. Those who aren't familiar with this platform, it is basically an AI who would be taking your interview. The question will be displayed on the screen and you will be given 30 secs to prepare for it, then you need to record your answer for 3 mins but you can stop anytime you complete giving your answer. They are basic HR questions. The company's people will be evaluating later as well. The questions were:

1. Why did you choose your current degree program?
2. What do you aim to gain from this internship?
3. Tell us about a challenging project experience.
4. How did you manage multiple priorities and time?

5. Tell us about a time when you realized you have a weakness and how did you try to overcome that?
6. What'd you like us to know more about you?

Tip: Try to include as many keywords of the company's values as possible. And give answers from personal experiences. Don't try to read it from script, speak naturally.

(**My Story:** We had a deadline at 3 PM, so I sat for my interview around 2 PM. Just as I began answering the first question, the doorbell rang. Since I stay in a PG, I assumed someone else would open it. But it rang again, and that broke my flow and I ended up fumbling through the next two questions. **Lesson:** if you live in a PG, inform your roommates beforehand and handle distractions like the doorbell early on. Also, choose the quietest spot possible and keep your phone on silent. After this shaky start, I honestly had no hopes of being shortlisted for further rounds. They sent the shortlist by 13th of August, and as expected my name was not included in the list. Devastated, demotivated and feeling lost, I started evaluating my next company's options. In the next hour, they sent an additional shortlist with 3 students' names included and my prayers were answered, my name was in that. It turned out 3 people in the original list were already placed so they removed them and included the next 3 :D. I spent the entire night going through my resume and revising CS fundamentals.)

3. **Technical Round** [35 students appeared, 16 shortlisted]

The offline interview was scheduled on 14th August, divided into 6 panels around 9:30 in the morning. And I was the first one to get interviewed in my panel. My panel consisted of two people, one sir was from AIML domain and there was another ma'am who was specializing in DevOps. It started on a light note with them asking, how I was feeling and how was the process till now for me. Then they asked for my introduction. Remember guys your introduction decides the flow for the rest of the interview, it should include your name, branch, proficiency in which languages, and your interest. I also included my projects and extracurricular activities, as well as my hackathon wins. Since Baker Hughes focused on sustainability and leadership, I had two projects related to it and my committee work to showcase those values. Then he asked to explain my first project, EcoVerse and focused on one particular feature which included giving ecofriendly alternatives of everyday products. I explained how we had scraped the data from another website and were using keyword based retrieval to display in the frontend. Then he asked me what if product category was not included in the dataset, then how would you classify the items, considering the same product can have different names with different brands, and also told me it was a large dataset which would simultaneously add new products on the fly. First, I came about the semantic similarity approach, which would retrieve on the basis of semantic meaning behind the product name so that even if the product has different names if their meaning is same they would still be considered equal, but they didn't seem satisfied with it. So, I thought about it for a minute and told them I would use KNN algorithm which would group similar products in one cluster and if a new datapoint were to arrive it would give recommendations with the nearest clusters. He later assured me that I was going in the right direction and asked me to come up with an approach that doesn't include a labelled dataset, so I said I would use K-means in that case and then asked me to explain the entire algorithm. The interviewers seemed satisfied with it. Later, he noticed I had a project that included OCR, so he inquired about what it does, and what challenges I will face if I worked on a real world dataset. I gave some problems, but he expected more, so I genuinely confessed as we had worked on a very structured dataset, these are the only problems we faced in our project. This seemed to convince him a bit. Later, he jumped

on some HR questions and asked what would I do if I were to get assigned to a monotonous task in the project? Then seeing how I had included React in almost all of my projects, inquired about why React and not Angular? I explained how I wanted to learn how to build end to end projects so after learning React, I shifted my focus on getting hands on backend development. Then ma'am asked me about my role as Carnival Executive head, why did I approach influencers as judges because in this generation anyone can be an influencer. To this I answered we onboarded only those influencers who have won some beauty pageant to have some relevance. She also asked if I had ever come across a situation where there was dispute in a group project and how did I handle it, what was my mindset? Then sir asked why I used MongoDB in my project and what was the need for it and its schema. Later the interview shifted to SQL, as I had mentioned in my introduction that I am proficient in it. He started off with basic questions, the difference between drop and truncate. Then asked which is faster delete or truncate. I answered truncate would be faster because delete includes a where condition, then he questioned me what if delete didn't have any condition then which would be faster, to this I again answered truncate but he looked at me doubtfully, so I confessed I was not sure. (Although later I found out I was right, he wanted an explanation but I was just giving an educated guess :P). Then I was asked how I would retrieve a unique row to which I first answered using the primary key of the table and select query, she later changed the question to unique values to which I answered using distinct keyword. Then I was asked the difference between rank and dense rank. It ended with them asking if I had any questions for them. I inquired how many years they have been working for Baker Hughes and what motivated them to join the company. (Bit of a bold move on my part xD, but they seemed to laugh it off and answered me.) This round lasted for about an hour for me.

I was not asked any questions related to DSA, OS, CCN some of the other students were asked in other panels. Including unique projects on your resume helps divert their attention there more, so try building such projects. And know the in and out about everything mentioned in your resume, even though it's a group project, it's important to know the entire flow of the project.

4. **Leadership Round** [16 candidates appeared, 9 were selected]

Within an hour of finishing my first round, I was called in for the second. Many candidates were still waiting to give their first, but that's the advantage of being among the earliest in your panel, make a good impression and you are set for the next round. The interview started off with her asking how my initial rounds of interviews went. I frankly answered that I wasn't expecting it to turn out this way and me coming to the final round. She was curious as to why I had this mindset. To which I told her about my previous experiences and how I used to get really nervous answering questions and was not able to clear other companies first rounds. So she asked what changed now. I answered I decided to just trust myself and god and go with the flow. I was asked to explain my favourite project, then asked me how many people were a part of it, I answered two. She asked what I would do if my teammate was not cooperating. Also asked situational questions if I were the product manager and the tech team has informed me that they won't be able to deliver the product in the given deadline, how would I handle this situation? Remember transparency and reliable product delivery are the core company values so answer these questions in that regard. Also, asked follow up questions like if the client was not ready to extend the deadline what would you do? To this I answered, I would first negotiate with the client if it were possible to drop certain functionalities so the tech team can speed up the process, because giving a non functioning and untested product is not a viable option. Then she noticed that I had used Power BI in one of my data analysis projects and asked me to explain it and later inquired if I knew any other power apps to which I honestly replied no. Later, questions about which upi app I used and why, if I could add

one more feature on it, what would it be were asked. She also put forth a technical question related to frauds happening on such apps and how would I handle them. The interview ended on a high note with me getting a chance to ask about her experience working for Baker Hughes, and she seemed very interested in answering my questions.

I was done with my interview and was waiting for the results. The process ended around 6 pm in the evening with **9 candidates receiving the offer**. I was just glad to be one of them 😊

Useful Tips:

1. For OA practice Aptitude from [IndiaBix](#) ,

OS: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8XBtAjKwCm4&t=249s> ,

OOPS: https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PL9gnSGHSqcnolG3XjUbWzXHL8_EttOuKk&si=gc49GVO2WGW2osZ ,

DSA strivers A-Z sheet,

SQL Leetcode 50 should be more than enough,

CCN, DBMS refer to GFG.

2. For Digital Interview, practice answering in front of a mirror or with a friend to build confidence and get a second perspective.
3. For tech rounds, be thorough with your resume, know answers to questions like why, how and what for all your projects. Keep answers ready for questions related to the choice of your tech stack and implementation, challenges and if you were to scale this project further what would you do? And remember only to use those technological terms while answering that you are sure about, if you say OCR be prepared for questions related to it. This comes very rarely but for two of my interviews I was told to write the code for my project on paper, so be prepared for it as well as schema design related questions.
4. For the HR round, familiarize yourself with standard questions. Maintain good body language and develop communication skills as it really affects the entire interview process. Research about the company well beforehand, this will show your eagerness to join. Don't allow awkward silence ever, keep the interview as engaging as possible.
5. **Don't get demotivated by rejections, it's okay to be sad for that day, but you gotta pick yourself up and prepare for the next companies. Try to not be that hard on yourself and take short breaks in between to avoid burn outs.** I remember having to prepare for Noumura and Barclays right after getting rejected from other companies. It's definitely not easy but trust me it will be more devastating if you let it affect your next opportunities. I even opted for meditation, practising Sudarshan Kriya in between the placements process to handle negative emotions. Know what works for you and maintain your physical as well as mental health. Lastly, I would just say **do your best and leave the rest to God.**

**WISHING YOU ALL THE VERY BEST!! TRUST YOURSELF AND GOD, EVEN IF YOU
DON'T SUCCEED BETTER OPPORTUNITIES ARE WAITING FOR YOU!!!**

Feel free to reach out: [LinkedIn](#)